

Chapter 92_1 - Su Mo

Han Ya and the others were right. Since Chu Qingqiu was now a mortal, she probably wouldn't have any memories, so she absolutely couldn't appear directly in her true identity. Otherwise, not only would it frighten her, but it might also disturb a mortal's fate.

So this disguise was purely instinctual.

However, when the woman's hand reached toward her forehead and nose, then habitually moved down to feel her pulse, she seemed quite skilled in medicine. Ning Fuyi's heart gradually began to pound.

If she understood medical arts, she would quickly discover that her pulse was calm and she had no injuries.

Since she was already pretending, she might as well see it through to the end. So Ning Fuyi didn't hesitate at all. She manipulated her immortal power to flow backward, immediately tasting something fishy and sweet in her throat, then bent over and spat out blood.

The woman was obviously startled, and the hand touching her wrist immediately withdrew to her chest.

The green grass swirled before her eyes, and Ning Fuyi's vision went black. This time she really did faint.

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Ning Fuyi's fainting wasn't a complete loss of consciousness. Her divine sense retained half its awareness, allowing her to hear the sounds outside. The woman initially seemed to hesitate for a long time, not wanting to get into trouble.

However, after pacing back and forth three times, Ning Fuyi still felt her ankle being tied with a hemp rope, her back scraping against the grass as she was dragged into the foothills.

The journey being dragged was really far. Although there were soft grass leaves beneath her, it still rubbed her back raw. Just when Ning Fuyi thought she was going to be tied up and buried in the deep mountains, the woman finally stopped, untied the rope, and half-dragged, half-carried her into a bamboo house by the river, placing her on a bed.

After an unknown amount of time, Ning Fuyi slowly came to, her phoenix eyes clear as she stared fixedly at the dilapidated but clean ceiling. The wooden bed beneath her was wide and hard, with only a layer of grass mat spread on it, making her shoulder blades ache.

She supported herself on the bed edge and raised her head. She didn't need to turn much to see the entire interior of this room, because the bamboo house was really too small, with very few belongings—one bed, one table, one chair.

All the valuable items were here.

Looking at this impoverished place, Ning Fuyi couldn't help but feel heartache. Had Chu Qingqiu been living like this all these years? In the past, although she disdained luxury, she had never done any manual labor and was provided with good food and tea.

Yet once she descended to the mortal realm, she lived in such destitution.

Just as she was thinking this, the door suddenly opened. A woman in green robes stepped over the threshold carrying a bowl of medicinal soup. Seeing the awakened Ning Fuyi, she obviously shrank back half a step.

Once Ning Fuyi's gaze fell on her, she couldn't look away. The woman was wrapped tightly from head to toe, her figure indiscernible, and the three layers of veil on her face remained untaken. But Ning Fuyi could tell at a glance that she was Chu Qingqiu.

Some things about a person, even if she reincarnated several times, still couldn't be erased.

However, she forgot about the aggressiveness of her own appearance—she clearly didn't look like a good person. Moreover, staring at someone like this made the woman's body tremble involuntarily. Her left hand held the medicine bowl while her right hand reached behind her.

Ning Fuyi caught a glimpse of cold light with her sharp eyes.

So she quickly lowered her head, pretending to be severely injured, clutching her chest and turning with groans. Her sweat-dampened hair stuck to her ears, making her appear somewhat fragile.

Only then did the cold light at the woman's waist finally dim. She didn't close the room door but slowly moved her feet, placing the medicine bowl beside the bed.

Her ten fingers moved flexibly, forming one gesture after another.

Ning Fuyi clutched her heart while watching those gestures, but unfortunately she didn't understand sign language. After watching for a long time without comprehending, the woman's dark brows furrowed slightly. She took out a stack of yellowed paper from a cabinet and wrote on it with an ink stick.

"Who are you? Why are you injured?"

Ning Fuyi immediately felt relieved and spoke: "I am..."

"A traveling merchant, living in the capital. This time I came to transport goods south, but unfortunately encountered bandits when passing through this area. They robbed my goods and I was severely injured, fortunately saved by the young lady."

While she spoke, the woman stared intently at her lip movements, then her brows relaxed somewhat, as if she understood.

Seeing that she was finally no longer so guarded, Ning Fuyi breathed a sigh of relief and tentatively asked: "May I ask the young lady's surname and name?"

The woman lowered her eyes and wrote two characters again: A Chou¹.

Ning Fuyi was startled, then her eyes caught sight of something, and her lips relaxed: "So the young lady's surname is Su, Su Mo?"

The woman immediately looked up defensively, stepping back repeatedly, her eyes full of panic.

What kind of grievances had she suffered to be so afraid of others? Ning Fuyi was secretly puzzled, but didn't dare frighten her further. She quickly pointed to a yellowed, blurry painting hanging on the wall.

She explained in a low voice: "Young lady, don't be afraid. I only saw the inscription there: 'To my daughter, Su Mo.'"

The woman's eyes still held lingering fear, like a deer in the forest startled by outsiders. Her hand reached for her waist again.

Ning Fuyi didn't know how to dispel her fear, so she could only sit motionless in place, making her face even paler to create the illusion that she was indeed severely injured and unable to move.

After a long while like this, the woman finally relaxed a bit more, put away the cold light, and pointed to the medicinal soup by the bedside.

Ning Fuyi really didn't dare say anything more. She quickly and obediently picked up the medicine bowl, drinking it all in gulps, and even showed the woman the empty bottom of the bowl.

It was somewhat strange for someone with such cold features to make such gestures, but it looked a bit clumsy, reducing the sense of oppression.

Only then did Su Mo's constantly trembling body stabilize somewhat. She didn't step forward but leaned against the wall, raising her hand to point toward the unclosed door.

Footnote:

¹ **A Chou** (阿丑): A name meaning "Ugly Girl," used as a derogatory nickname.